

Power of Interest
Privacy/GDPR Policy

Version: 0.2

Approved by: Maria Fargher

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Power of Interest is committed to protecting your privacy and looking after your personal information. This privacy notice explains how we collect, use, and store personal data about our teenage debate participants and their parents or guardians.

Who We Are

We are Power of Interest, a registered charity in England and Wales (Charity Number: 17391401). For the purposes of data protection law, we are the "Data Controller" of your personal information.

Contact Email: contact@poi.org.uk

Address: 82 Merion Road, Botley, Southampton, England, SO32 2SR

What Information We Collect and Why

We only collect the minimum amount of information needed to run our debates safely and legally. We recognise that we process children's personal information and take additional care to protect it in accordance with UK GDPR.

- **From Parents/Guardians:** Name, email address, phone number, and emergency contact details. We use this to get parental consent, communicate event details, and contact you in an emergency.
- **From Teenage Participants:** Name, age/date of birth, year group, school type, school (optional), and any access or dietary requirements for in-person events. We use this to ensure debates are age-appropriate and safe.
- **Online Data:** When you join our online debates, we process your screen name and visual/audio data (if your camera and microphone are turned on).
- **Photographs and Videos:** We may take photographs or videos during our activities. We will only use images or recordings that identify you if we have explicit consent from you or, if you are under 18, from your parent/guardian. With consent, these may be used on our website, social media, newsletters, and other promotional materials.

Our Legal Basis for Using Your Data

Under the UK GDPR, we rely on the following legal grounds to handle your data:

- **Consent:** We ask parents/guardians for explicit consent to allow participants under the age of 18 to participate, and separate consent if we take photos or video recordings.
- **Legal Obligation:** We must keep certain records (like attendance registers and safeguarding incident logs) to comply with our health, safety, and youth safeguarding laws.
- **Legitimate Interests:** We use your data to manage and administer our debating events efficiently.

How We Keep Online Debates Safe and Private

No Public Recording: We do not record online debates unless we have received explicit, written consent from a parent or guardian beforehand.

Platform Security: We use secure online platforms (like Zoom or Teams) with waiting rooms and passwords to stop uninvited people from joining. These organisations should also process data on our behalf on the basis of applicable terms and conditions.

No Private Contact: Our staff and volunteers will never contact teenage participants privately via social media or email. All communications go through parents or official charity channels.

Sharing Your Information

We will never sell your data or share it with third parties for marketing purposes. We only share information when:

- We use secure digital tools to run our charity (e.g., secure email providers, Zoom, or password-protected cloud storage).
- Where you or, if you are under 18, your parent/guardian has given explicit consent for photographs or videos to be used, we may share these through our website, social media channels, newsletters, or other promotional materials to showcase and promote our activities.
- We are legally required to do so, such as for a vital medical emergency or a youth safeguarding issue.

How Long We Keep Your Data

We only keep your personal information for as long as it is needed to run our programs, or as long as the law requires us to keep it.

Record	Retention
Registration Forms	1 Year
Consent forms	3 Years
Safeguarding records	As required by safeguarding guidance
Trustee records	6 Years
Financial records	6 years
Photos and Videos	1 year

Your Rights

You and your child have rights over your personal data. You can ask us to:

- See what information we hold about you.
- Fix any mistakes in your information.
- Delete your information from our systems.
- Withdraw your consent at any time (e.g., asking us to delete a photo or stop sending emails).

To exercise any of these rights, please email us at alan@poi.org.uk. We would appreciate the opportunity to address your concerns before you contact the ICO. However, if you are unhappy with how we handle your data, you have the right to complain to the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) at ico.org.uk.